ACME CORP

OFFICIAL SALES PLAYBOOK

Sales Playbook

Strategies, processes & tools for consistent revenue growth

Company & ICP · Sales Process · Discovery · Objections · Competitive · Tools & Tech · Metrics & Comp

SalesCoach AI

Internal Use Only · Confidential · FY 2025

Version 3.2 · Q1 2025

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Company Overview & Mission

Acme Corp is a B2B SaaS platform that helps mid-market and enterprise revenue teams build more predictable pipelines, coach reps at scale, and close deals faster. Founded in 2018 and headquartered in San Francisco, we serve over 1,200 customers across North America and EMEA, with ARR growing 60% YoY.

Our Mission

To make every sales rep perform like the top 10% — through intelligent coaching, real-time deal guidance, and data-driven pipeline management.

What We Sell

Core Platform	AI-powered sales coaching, call intelligence, and pipeline analytics — sold as an annual S
Accelerator	Deal intelligence layer: real-time alerts, competitive tracking, and forecast accuracy engine
Coaching Studio	Manager-facing module: rep scorecards, skill gap analysis, and personalised coaching wo
Professional Svcs	Onboarding, methodology implementation (MEDDIC/SPIN), and ongoing CSM support.

Our Positioning

We are the only platform that combines **call intelligence, deal execution guidance, and manager coaching** in a single workflow — rather than requiring three separate tools. Our core differentiation: we surface the right insight at the right moment in the deal cycle, not in a quarterly business review.

Dimension	Acme Corp	Competitors
Intelligence layer	Real-time, in-deal	Post-call / retrospective
Coaching model	Automated + manager-led	Manual / human-only
Methodology support	MEDDIC, SPIN, BANT, custom	Generic or none
Forecast accuracy	AI-driven, 90%+ accuracy	CRM-dependent estimates
Time to value	< 30 days to first insight	60–90 day implementation

1 Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Who we sell to — and who we don't

Our ICP is refined from our top 200 accounts by ACV, NRR, and time-to-value. Selling outside this profile significantly increases sales cycle length, lowers win rates, and correlates with high churn. Qualify hard on these dimensions.

Primary ICP

Company Size	200–5,000 employees. Sweet spot: 500–2,000. Below 100 = low ACV, above 10,000 = lon
Revenue	$20M–$500M ARR. Growth-stage or scaling companies with a VP/CRO investing in GTM
Sales Org Size	15–150 quota-carrying reps. Enough reps to justify coaching at scale; enough mgrs to buy
Segment	B2B SaaS, Tech, Financial Services, Professional Services, Healthcare SaaS. Strong neg
Geography	North America (primary), UK & DACH (secondary). APAC in FY26.
Sales Motion	Outbound-led or hybrid. Companies with inbound-only motions see lower lift. Mid-market A
Tech Stack	Salesforce or HubSpot CRM (required for integration). Gong/Chorus users = strong positiv
Pain Triggers	Missing quota 2+ consecutive quarters, recent VP of Sales hire, Series B/C/D fundraise, s

Buyer Personas

Persona	Title	Primary Pain	Our Hook	Key Message
Economic Buyer	CRO / VP Sales	Missed quota, forecast misses	Pipeline predictability	We improve forecast accuracy by 30%+ in 60 days
Champion	Sr. Dir. Sales Enablement	Rep ramp time, inconsistent skills	Coaching at scale	Cut ramp time in half with automated skill coaching
Technical Buyer	RevOps / Sales Ops	CRM data quality, tool sprawl	Native Salesforce integration	One platform replaces three tools, no CRM admin bur
End User	AE / SDR	Not enough time, unclear next steps	In-deal guidance	Your AI co-pilot tells you exactly what to do next.

Negative ICP — Qualify Out

✗ Fewer than 10 quota-carrying reps — ACV too low to justify.

✗ No dedicated sales manager or enablement function.
✗ CRM is spreadsheets, Notion, or a non-integrated tool.
✗ Pure PLG or inbound-only motion with no outbound or AE team.
✗ CFO-led buying process with 9+ month budget cycle on sub-$50K deals.
✗ Currently in a technology freeze (post-acquisition, major platform migration).

2 Sales Process & Stage Definitions

Our 7-stage revenue engine — standardised across all segments

Every deal in Salesforce must reflect the current stage accurately. Stage inflation is a leading indicator of forecast failure. Managers review stage definitions in every weekly pipeline call. When in doubt, move it back.

S1	**Prospecting** (0%)	Account identified, not yet contacted. Research complete. ICP score assigned.	**Exit:** ICP fit confirmed, contact identified, outreach sequence launched.
S2	**Discovery** (10%)	First meaningful conversation held. Pain hypothesis being tested.	**Exit:** At least one pain area confirmed, next meeting scheduled.
S3	**Qualified** (20%)	MEDDIC elements partially complete. EB identified. Budget range established.	**Exit:** Pain quantified, EB engaged, decision process mapped.
S4	**Solution Fit** (40%)	Demo or POC completed. Mutual success plan drafted.	**Exit:** Buyer confirms fit. At least two stakeholders aligned.
S5	**Proposal** (60%)	Commercial proposal delivered. Decision criteria formally agreed.	**Exit:** Verbal approval from EB. Legal/procurement engaged.
S6	**Negotiation** (80%)	Contract in redline. Pricing finalised. Security/legal review underway.	**Exit:** Final contract agreed. PO process initiated.
S7	**Closed Won/Lost** (100%)	Deal is closed. CRM updated with win/loss reason and competitive notes.	**Exit:** N/A — post-mortem completed within 48 hours.

Pipeline Hygiene Rules

- No deal stays in S2 for more than 14 days without a logged next step.
- S3+ requires an identified Economic Buyer in the CRM contact record.
- S5+ requires a signed NDA, security questionnaire initiated, and a mutual close plan.
- Any deal with no activity in 21 days is auto-flagged as 'At Risk' — rep must update or move to S1.
- Win/loss reasons are mandatory fields — incomplete records block commission processing.

3 Discovery & Qualification

We use MEDDIC as our primary qualification framework

Every Acme AE is expected to use MEDDIC to qualify deals from S2 onwards. MEDDIC score is tracked in Salesforce and reviewed in every deal review. A deal with a MEDDIC score below 8 cannot be moved to S5.

Why MEDDIC

Teams using MEDDIC at Acme average a 28% higher win rate and 22% shorter sales cycle than those that don't. It removes subjectivity from forecasting and gives managers a common language for coaching.

MEDDIC in the Acme Context

Metrics	What KPI is broken? Typical metrics: quota attainment %, ramp time (days), forecast accu
Economic Buyer	Usually CRO or VP Sales. Must be engaged by S3. If you haven't spoken with the EB by S
Decision Criteria	Formal: integration requirements, security posture, Salesforce compatibility. Informal: bran
Decision Process	Typical: pilot → security review → legal → CFO approval → PO. Map this at S3 and updat
Identify Pain	Top pain categories: missed quota (83% of wins), slow ramp (61%), poor forecast visibility
Champion	Typically Sr. Dir. Enablement or RevOps. Test: will they share the evaluation scorecard? V

Discovery Question Bank — Acme-Specific

Pain & Metrics

→ What percentage of your reps hit quota last year — and what does your leadership think is driving that number?

→ How long does it take a new AE to carry a full quota? What would cutting that in half mean for this year's number?

→ When your CRO asks for a forecast on Monday, how confident are you that it's accurate? What's the typical miss rate?

→ Where in the funnel are you losing deals you feel you should be winning?

Economic Buyer & Process

→ Who ultimately owns the sales enablement or RevOps budget for an investment like this?

→ Has budget been earmarked for this, or does it need to be justified from scratch?
→ What does your internal approval process look like for a SaaS investment of this size?
→ Is there a board-level mandate or OKR that this project connects to?

4 Objection Handling Guide

The 8 objections we hear most — and how to navigate them

Objections are buying signals in disguise. An objecting prospect is engaged — they are just asking for help resolving a concern. Never argue. Always **Acknowledge** → **Clarify** → **Respond** → **Confirm**.

'We already use Gong/Chorus.'

Gong records and transcribes. We act on what's in the recording. Our deal-intelligence layer reads the conversation and tells the rep what to do next — Gong doesn't do that. In fact, 38% of our customer base uses both tools together. Can I show you how they complement each other?

'We don't have budget right now.'

I understand — budget is always a constraint. Can I ask: is this a priority problem or a budget problem? Most of our customers find the budget by reallocating from tools with lower ROI. What's the cost of missing quota for another quarter while you wait?

'We're too small / not ready yet.'

Fair point — our minimum viable use case is 15 reps and one sales manager. If you're below that, I'd rather be honest and reconnect when you're at scale. If you're close, let's talk about what 'ready' looks like and whether there's a pilot path.

'We built something internally.'

That's impressive — what does it do today? In our experience, internal tools handle the data layer well but struggle with the coaching layer and manager workflows. What's the one thing your internal tool can't do that would most move the needle?

'We need to involve our IT/security team and that takes months.'

Completely understandable — and we built for that. We have a dedicated security portal, SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001, and a standard DPIA template. Most of our customers clear IT review in 2–3 weeks. Can I connect your security team directly with our solutions engineer?

'We tried something like this before and it didn't stick.'

I really appreciate you sharing that — it helps me understand the risk you're protecting against. What broke down — was it the technology, the adoption, or the ROI story? Our onboarding is specifically designed around the adoption failures our customers experienced elsewhere. Can I show you what that looks like?

'Your price is too high.'

Compared to what? If it's competitor X, let's look at the full TCO — their implementation fees are typically 40% of the first-year cost. If it's your budget ceiling, let's talk about what a phased deployment looks like. What's the number that makes this a comfortable conversation?

'We need to see an ROI before we can commit.'

Absolutely — let's build that together. I'll need 30 minutes with your RevOps lead and access to 3 data points: current quota attainment, average ramp time, and annual new hire volume. From there we can model a conservative case in under a week. Would that work?

5 Competitive Battle Cards

How to position against our four main competitors

This section summarises our competitive positioning. Full battle cards are in Highspot under *Sales Resources > Competitive Intelligence*. Update your manager immediately if you encounter a competitor not listed here.

Competitor A — The Incumbent

Their story: Legacy call recording platform, strong brand. Weak on deal intelligence and manager coaching. Long-term customers are often locked in by habit, not value.

Our counter: Our real-time deal guidance vs their retrospective reporting. Ask: 'What does Competitor A tell your reps to do differently after reviewing a call?' (They can't answer — they don't have that.)

Competitor B — The Point Solution

Their story: Strong coaching module but no pipeline or forecast layer. Often bought by enablement teams without CRO buy-in. Low ACV, high churn after Year 1.

Our counter: Land with the CRO, not just enablement. 'Competitor B is a coaching tool. We connect coaching outcomes directly to revenue. Your CRO will care about one of those, not both.'

Competitor C — The Platform Player

Their story: Large CRM suite add-on. Expensive, slow to implement, requires Salesforce admin resources. Wins on brand trust, not product capability.

Our counter: Speed and focus. 'Competitor C takes 90 days to deploy and requires a dedicated admin. Our customers see first insights in 14 days with zero admin burden. What does your timeline look like?'

Build Internally

Their story: Engineering bandwidth is the constraint. Internal builds optimise for data collection, not coaching workflow. They also cannot iterate at the pace of our product roadmap.

Our counter: 'What does your current build cost per year in eng time? What features are on the backlog ' 'that haven't shipped? Our customers who tried to build typically spent 18 months and 3 engineers before buying anyway — what's your team's opportunity cost?'

6 Proposal & Pricing Strategy

Packaging, pricing bands & commercial guidelines

All pricing is subject to current rate card (available in Salesforce CPQ). Discounting beyond the guidelines below requires VP Sales approval. Present pricing only after the value case is established — never lead with price.

Product Tiers

Tier	Who It's For	Core Modules	Indicative ACV
Starter	SMB, <25 reps	Call intelligence, basic dashboard	$12K–$25K
Growth	Mid-market, 25–75 reps	Call intelligence, deal guidance, coaching studio	$25K–$80K
Enterprise	75–200+ reps	Full platform + RevOps suite + dedicated CSM	$80K–$250K
Strategic	200+ reps, multi-team	Custom build, professional services, exec coaching	$250K+

Discounting Guidelines

Up to 10%	AE authority. No approval needed. Use for multi-year commitments or reference customer
10–20%	Manager approval required. Must be accompanied by documented justification (competitiv
20–30%	VP Sales + Finance approval. Reserved for marquee logos, large expansions, or competit
> 30%	Executive approval (CRO). Rare — must have board-level strategic rationale.

Proposal Best Practices

- **Never send a proposal cold.** A proposal without a verbal pricing conversation almost never closes. Anchor the number in a call before sending the document.
- **Always lead with the business case.** Page 1 of every proposal should show the prospect's pain in their numbers, your projected impact, and the ROI timeline.
- **Offer two options, not one.** A single-option proposal invites a yes/no decision. Two options (e.g., Growth vs. Enterprise) invite a conversation about fit.
- **Attach the mutual close plan.** Every S5+ proposal should include a timeline from proposal to go-live, with named milestones and owners.

- **Set a proposal expiry.** Standard proposals are valid for 30 days. This creates urgency without pressure and keeps forecasting clean.

7 Closing & Negotiation

Earn the decision — don't force it

At Acme, we do not use high-pressure close techniques. Our close rate improves when we invest in need development and champion enablement rather than urgency tactics. That said, strong closers are proactive about removing obstacles, creating urgency through business value, and advancing deals with clear next steps.

The Mutual Close Plan

Every S5 deal should have a co-created Mutual Close Plan (MCP) shared with the prospect. The MCP contains:

Goal State	What the customer is trying to achieve and by when.
Milestones	Each step from proposal to go-live — with date and owner (both sides).
Dependencies	Legal review, security questionnaire, IT sign-off, PO process timeline.
Success Metrics	How we will both measure whether the implementation was successful.
Escalation Path	Named contacts on both sides if anything gets stuck.

Negotiation Principles

- **Anchor on value, not price.** Before any negotiation starts, re-establish the business case. Discount conversations are harder when the ROI is vivid.
- **Trade, don't give.** Every concession should come with a request: 'If I can find room on price, can we move the signature date to this Friday?'
- **Protect the rate card.** Discounts set precedent for renewals. Consider non-price concessions first: extended payment terms, additional licences, professional services credits.
- **Involve your champion.** If procurement is pushing on price, ask your champion to advocate internally: 'What do you think the right response to this is?'
- **Know your walk-away number.** Confirm with your manager before any final negotiation call what the floor is. Never negotiate against yourself.

Closing Signal	The strongest closing signal is when your champion tells you: 'We've made the decision — it's just procurement now.' At that point, your job is obstacle removal. Work the MCP, accelerate legal, and keep your champion engaged through to signature.

8 Sales Tools & Tech Stack

Every rep's essential toolkit — and how to use it

Our tech stack is designed to minimise admin and maximise selling time. All tools below are mandatory unless marked optional. Failure to log deals accurately in Salesforce will result in commission delays.

Tool	Category	Primary Use	Rep Action Required
Salesforce	CRM	Deal/contact management, forecasting	Update within 24hrs of every interaction
Acme Platform	Own Product	Call recording, deal guidance, coaching	Review AI-generated next steps after every call
Outreach	Sequencing	Prospecting sequences, email cadences	Build sequences from approved templates only
LinkedIn Sales Nav	Prospecting	Account research, stakeholder mapping	Export contacts to Salesforce; no cold outreach outside seque
Highspot	Content	Proposals, battle cards, case studies	Only share Highspot-hosted content externally
Gong (optional)	Call review	Secondary call recording backup	Optional — Acme platform is primary
Clari	Forecasting	Weekly pipeline review, forecast submission	Submit forecast every Monday by 9am
DocuSign	eSignature	Contract execution	All contracts via DocuSign — no PDF attachments

CRM Hygiene Non-Negotiables

✓ Every call, email, and meeting logged same day — no exceptions.
✓ Next step field populated on every open opportunity at all times.
✓ Economic Buyer contact record created and linked by S3.
✓ Close date must reflect the realistic signature date, not an aspirational one.
✓ Competitive field populated at S3 — 'Unknown' is not acceptable past that stage.

9 Metrics, Quotas & Compensation

How performance is measured and rewarded

Core Sales Metrics — FY 2025 Targets

Metric	SDR Target	SMB AE Target	MM AE Target	Ent AE Target
Quota (ACV)	—	$400K	$700K	$1.2M
Pipe coverage ratio	4x quota gen	3.5x	4x	4.5x
Win rate	—	>25%	>30%	>28%
Avg sales cycle	—	< 45 days	< 75 days	< 120 days
Avg ACV	—	$22K	$55K	$140K
Activities/day	40 touches	25 activities	20 activities	15 activities

Compensation Structure Overview

Base / Variable	70/30 split for AEs. 60/40 for SMB. Base paid monthly, variable paid quarterly.
Accelerators	100–110% of quota: 1.0x multiplier. 110–125%: 1.25x. 125%+: 1.5x. Accelerators apply re
Multi-year deals	2-year deals: 1.5x credit on Year 2 ACV. 3-year: 1.75x. Max credit capped at 1 year of TC
SPIFs	Announced quarterly. Typical SPIFs: strategic product lines, competitive displacement, ne
Clawbacks	Deals cancelled within 90 days of close are subject to clawback. Churn driven by mis-sold
Ramp	New AEs receive 50% quota in Month 1–2, 75% in Month 3, full quota from Month 4.

Commission Processing

All commissions are processed on the 15th of the month following quarter close. CRM data as of midnight on the last day of the quarter is the system of record. Late-logged deals are not eligible for retroactive commission in the prior period.

10 Onboarding & Ramp Expectations

What the first 90 days look like for a new Acme AE

Our ramp programme is designed to get new AEs to full productivity in 90 days. It combines structured learning, shadowing, and live deal work. Your manager is your primary coach — but the Acme platform will also surface real-time guidance tailored to your skill gaps throughout ramp.

Days 1–30 Foundation

→ Complete Acme Platform certification (required by Day 10).

→ Learn our ICP, value proposition, and messaging guide inside-out.

→ Shadow 5+ discovery calls with a tenured AE each week.

→ Complete MEDDIC and SPIN training modules in SalesCoach AI.

→ Build your first 20 target accounts with full ICP scoring in Salesforce.

→ Deliver a mock discovery call to your manager by Day 30.

Days 31–60 Activation

→ Take ownership of 2–4 active deals from your manager or SDR team.

→ Lead discovery and qualification calls independently with manager listening.

→ Attend weekly pipeline review — present deals using MEDDIC framework.

→ Deliver first live demo (manager co-presents if needed).

→ Complete objection handling certification with your enablement partner.

→ Quota in this period: 75% of full monthly target.

Days 61–90 Independence

→ Carry full pipeline independently — manager available for escalation only.

→ Run your first commercial negotiation (manager available to shadow).

→ Contribute to a deal review in the weekly team session.

→ Complete 90-day self-assessment using the AE Scorecard.

→ Set Q2 goal with manager: quota, skill development area, and target accounts.

→ Quota in this period: full monthly target.

Success Metrics at Day 90

Milestone	Target
Certifications completed	Acme Platform, MEDDIC, SPIN, Product Demo
Active pipeline generated	3x quota coverage minimum
Discovery calls led	15+ independently
MEDDIC score on open deals	Average > 8/12
Manager assessment	Ready for full quota — no PIP risk

This Sales Playbook is a living document — updated quarterly. Last revision: Q1 2025. For corrections or additions, contact the Revenue Enablement team. Acme Corp · Internal Use Only · © 2025.